VIT BHOPAL

DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

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INTRODUCTION

I have been selected as a Student Digital Ambassador at my college. My primary responsibility is to assist my peers in navigating the digital world safely and professionally. This project documents my journey in creating a Digital Literacy Portfolio. Through five distinct modules, I have worked on creating visual resources, building a professional online presence, exploring collaboration tools, mastering email etiquette, and understanding cybercrime prevention. This report serves as a comprehensive record of these tasks and my reflections on digital literacy.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Description & Tool Used:

To complete this task, I used Canva, a free browser-based design tool, to create a one-page visual resource titled "Navigating the Digital World: An Ambassador's Guide". As a Student Digital Ambassador, my goal was to provide a clear roadmap for my peers to improve their digital fluency. The infographic is divided into four strategic sections:

- Useful Digital Tools: Highlighting GitHub for projects, Canva for design, and LinkedIn for networking.
- Safe Internet Practices: Emphasizing Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) and password security.
- Email Etiquette: Outlining the importance of clear subject lines and formal greetings.
- Professional Presence: Guiding students on how to showcase skills online.

Content Overview:

The design showcases essential tools like GitHub for project storage and LinkedIn for professional networking. For safety, it emphasizes Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) and the importance of never sharing OTPs. Furthermore, it provides quick tips for professional communication, such as using formal greetings and maintaining a clean online profile to showcase skills effectively.

Reflection:

What I found most interesting while creating this infographic was the challenge of data condensation. It was difficult to take broad topics like cyber hygiene and professional branding and shrink them into short, punchy bullet points without losing their meaning. This process taught me that effective digital literacy is not just about having technical knowledge, but also about communicating that knowledge in a way that is visually engaging and easy for others to digest quickly.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

Description & Tool Used:

For this task, I created my digital presence across three key platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each of these platforms serves a different purpose in building a strong and professional online identity.

- GitHub:It is primarily used for storing and showcasing coding projects. I created a profile README to introduce myself, including my academic background and learning goals. This will serve as a foundation for displaying my future projects.
- LinkedIn: It is a professional networking platform. I updated my profile by adding my education details, including my degree, institution, and expected graduation year. This platform will help me connect with peers, seniors, and professionals, and explore internship opportunities.
- Kaggle:It is a platform focused on data science and machine learning. I created my profile to begin exploring datasets and understanding how data-driven problem solving works in real-world scenarios.

Content Overview:

This task helped establish a foundational digital portfolio. GitHub provides a space to document and showcase future technical work. LinkedIn helps in building a professional identity and connecting with peers and industry professionals. Kaggle introduces exposure to real-world datasets and the basics of data science. Together, these platforms form the starting point of a strong digital presence for academic and career growth.

Reflection:

While setting up these platforms, I realized that building a professional online presence requires clarity and consistency rather than complexity. At my current stage, the focus is on creating a clean and honest profile rather than showcasing advanced skills. This task also helped me understand how these platforms can be used over time to track progress, build credibility, and prepare for future opportunities.

Task 3: Exploring Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Description & Tool Used:

For this task, I explored both a coding practice platform and a collaboration tool. I used HackerRank to practice basic coding and Google Forms to create a digital literacy awareness quiz.

- HackerRank:On HackerRank, I completed a beginner-level problem, which helped me understand how coding platforms are structured and how problems are solved in an online environment.
- Google Forms:For collaboration, I created a Google Form titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" consisting of five questions related to safe internet practices, digital tools, and professional communication.

Content Overview:

This task introduced me to two important categories of platforms. Coding platforms like HackerRank help in improving logical thinking and programming skills through structured challenges. Google Forms, on the other hand, is a useful tool for creating surveys and quizzes, and collecting responses efficiently.

Reflection:

This task helped me understand how digital platforms can support both learning and collaboration. Practicing coding on HackerRank gave me exposure to problem-solving in a structured format, while creating a Google Form showed how easily information can be shared and collected. These tools will be useful for academic work, skill development, and collaboration in the future.

Task 4: Email Etiquette and Responsible Communication

Description & Tool Used:

For this task, I drafted two professional emails to understand and apply proper email etiquette. The first email was written to a professor requesting an extension for an assignment submission, and the second email was addressed to an internship coordinator expressing interest in internship opportunities.

Additionally, I created a social media Do's and Don'ts checklist to promote responsible online behavior among students.

Content Overview:

This task focused on the importance of clear and professional digital communication. The emails included key elements such as a clear subject line, formal greeting, structured body, and polite sign-off. The social media checklist highlighted responsible practices such as maintaining professionalism, protecting personal information, and avoiding harmful or misleading content. Together, these components emphasize how communication plays a crucial role in building a positive digital presence.

Reflection:

One situation where poor digital communication can cause problems is when a student sends an informal or unclear email to a professor, such as without a subject line or proper greeting. This can lead to misunderstandings or even being ignored. Such issues can be avoided by following basic email etiquette and maintaining a respectful tone. This task helped me understand that even small details in communication can significantly impact how messages are perceived.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study and Prevention

Description & Tool Used:

For this task, I explored the topic of UPI and online payment fraud, which is one of the most common cybercrimes in India. I created a case study explaining how such frauds typically occur, who is targeted, and their consequences.
Additionally, I developed a prevention checklist to help users stay safe while using digital platforms.

Content Overview:

The case study explains how attackers use methods such as fake calls, messages, and UPI collect requests to trick users into transferring money or sharing sensitive information. It highlights how a lack of awareness can lead to financial loss and data theft. The prevention checklist provides practical steps such as avoiding sharing OTPs, verifying payment requests, and using secure passwords. It also includes official reporting channels like the National Cyber Crime Portal and helpline number 1930.

Reflection:

What surprised me the most was how simple tactics are used to carry out serious frauds, especially by exploiting a lack of awareness. I realized that even basic mistakes, such as approving a payment request without checking, can lead to financial loss. As a result, I will be more cautious while handling online transactions and ensure that I verify all requests before taking any action.

Conclusion

This project helped me understand the importance of digital literacy in today's world. Through different tasks, I learned how to use digital tools effectively, maintain a professional online presence, and communicate responsibly. I also explored platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank, which are essential for academic and career growth.

Additionally, I gained awareness about cybercrime and the importance of staying safe while using digital platforms. Overall, this project improved my understanding of how to use technology in a responsible, productive, and professional manner. These skills will be useful throughout my academic journey and future career.

References

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- Kaggle – https://www.kaggle.com
- HackerRank – https://www.hackerrank.com
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- National Cyber Crime Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in